

TIANYU ZHANG

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Providence, Rhode Island, USA

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Fine Arts (BFA) in Art and Computation | Rhode Island School of Design (RISD)

September 2024 – May 2028 (Expected) | Providence, RI, USA

- Concentration: Nature–Culture–Sustainability Studies (NCSS)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Fellow — RI-NEST SURF Program | University of Rhode Island & RISD

May 2026 – July 2026 | Kingston, RI

- Selected for the competitive 2026 Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (SURF) funded by NSF EPSCoR.
- Project: “Blue-Cycle: Emissions and Environmental Impacts of Recycling and Remanufacturing Plastic and Bioplastics in the Ocean State.”
- Mentors: Dr. Vinka Oyandel-Craver (URI College of Engineering) & Dr. Jennifer Bissonnette (RISD Nature Lab).
- Conducting emissions characterization, particulate analysis, and life-cycle assessment (LCA) of recycled plastic and bioplastic materials.

EXHIBITIONS & ARTISTIC PROJECTS

For documentation and photos of all works, please visit the artist's portfolio: [instagram.com/fc9_art](https://www.instagram.com/fc9_art)

Monitoring a Coral | Published in Vision Magazine; Exhibited at Brown University

May 2026 | Providence, RI

An electronic sculpture exploring the boundaries of technological surveillance and its relationship to the natural world. The work questions whether nature retains meaning when rendered entirely monitorable, and asks whether progress — measured by our capacity to control — risks redefining what is worthy of existence.

The Balcony Is Not Your Whole World / Two Heads Bird | Yi Du Wen Cha (One Degree Difference) — Group Exhibition

August 3 – September 25, 2025 | Shenzhen, China

A series of large-scale ink paintings (up to 48×72 in.) depicting fantastical creatures drawn from observations in nature labs and online 3D environments. The works explore personal resilience and the metaphor of a private interior space that storms cannot reach.

Depress Chocolate | CTC Major Group Exhibition

December 2025 | Waterman Gallery, Providence, RI

An installation examining emotional vulnerability, craving, and dreams — reflecting on the self in displacement and finding a strange fascination in fear as a form of self-revelation.

My PiXiu | Immersive Worlds — Wintersession Group Exhibition

January 2025 | Providence, RI

A sculptural work combining Chinese mythological imagery with family archive photographs taken by the artist's late grandfather in 1980s China. The piece explores ancestral connection, inherited memory, and the sacred.

Bones | EFS Group Exhibition

January 2025 | Waterman Gallery, Providence, RI

Observational charcoal drawings of human skeletal structures.

AWARDS & HONORS

- Forbes China Top 100 Emerging Young Artists | Forbes China — September 2023, China
- RI-NEST SURF Fellowship 2026 | Rhode Island Network for Excellence in Science & Technology (NSF EPSCoR) — May 2026, Rhode Island, USA